MacroLens Daily Brief — July 22, 2026

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Top Headlines

1. **Escalating Middle East war could slash global growth to 1.3% in 2026, World Bank chief economist says - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 10:31
   World Bank chief economist warns an escalating Middle East war could cut global growth to 1.3% in 2026.

2. **Oil prices jump on US-Iran strikes, stocks flat ahead of Big Tech results - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 00:49
   Oil prices jumped on US-Iran strikes, while stocks were flat ahead of Big Tech earnings.

3. **Oil settles up more than 3% to six-week high as Mideast conflict threatens oil transit routes - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 00:26
   Oil settled up over 3% to a six-week high as Mideast conflict threatens oil transit routes.

4. **Trump: US will attack Iranian bridge, power plant for every ship targeted in Hormuz - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 13:40
   Trump threatened US attacks on Iranian bridges and power plants for each ship targeted in Hormuz.

5. **Mideast war escalation threatens recovery in global oil refining - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 06:48
   Escalating Mideast war threatens the recovery in global oil refining.

6. **Rupee languishes at two-month lows as supply worries raise oil prices - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 02:59
   The rupee fell to two-month lows as supply worries pushed oil prices higher.

7. **Hormuz vessel crossings fall further as security concerns linger - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 02:54
   Vessel crossings through Hormuz declined further due to lingering security concerns.

8. **Gold firms to two-week peak on softer dollar, Fed outlook in focus - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 01:51
   Gold firmed to a two-week peak on a softer dollar and focus on Fed outlook.

9. **Dollar edges lower after four-day run of gains, yen stalled near 40-year low - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 00:54
   The dollar edged lower after four days of gains; the yen stalled near a 40-year low.

10. **EXCLUSIVE: Iran strikes on CIA facilities prompt questions about possible Russian role - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-22 19:33
   Iran strikes on CIA facilities raised questions about possible Russian involvement.

Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	748.28	+0.83%	bullish
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	708.97	+1.85%	bullish
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	521.51	+0.69%	bullish
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	296.54	+1.45%	bullish
XLK	Technology ETF	180.78	+2.89%	bullish
XLF	Financials ETF	56.11	+0.12%	neutral
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	81.89	-0.09%	neutral
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	93.31	-0.25%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	83.66	-0.27%	neutral
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	106.85	-0.28%	neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.65	-0.04%	neutral
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	374.81	+1.96%	bullish
SLV	Silver ETF	53.08	+4.12%	bullish
USO	Oil ETF	128.85	+2.66%	bullish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.40	+1.07%	bullish

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	28.48	+0.32%	neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	105.23	-0.13%	neutral
FXY	Japanese Yen ETF	56.22	-0.43%	neutral
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	66505.12	+1.95%	bullish
ETH-USD	Ethereum	1928.38	+1.29%	bullish

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate Target	3.5% – 3.75%	2026-07-22
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.28	2026-07-22
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.36	2026-07-22
VIX	17.05	2026-07-21
USD Index (Broad)	120.5315	2026-07-17

Major Anomalies

SLV — Silver ETF `+4.12%`

Cause: Silver surged on safe-haven demand amid escalating Iran tensions and potential Russian involvement.

Forward Impact: Geopolitical uncertainty could keep silver elevated, but a de-escalation would likely trigger a sharp pullback.

XLK — Technology ETF `+2.89%`

Cause: Technology sector rallied on positive earnings sentiment and Amazon's AI job cuts signaling strategic focus.

Forward Impact: Continued AI and earnings momentum may sustain tech outperformance, but geopolitical risks could cause volatility.

USO — Oil ETF `+2.66%`

Cause: Oil prices rose on supply disruption fears from Iran conflict and geopolitical instability.

Forward Impact: Oil may remain volatile with upside risk if tensions escalate, but demand concerns could cap gains.

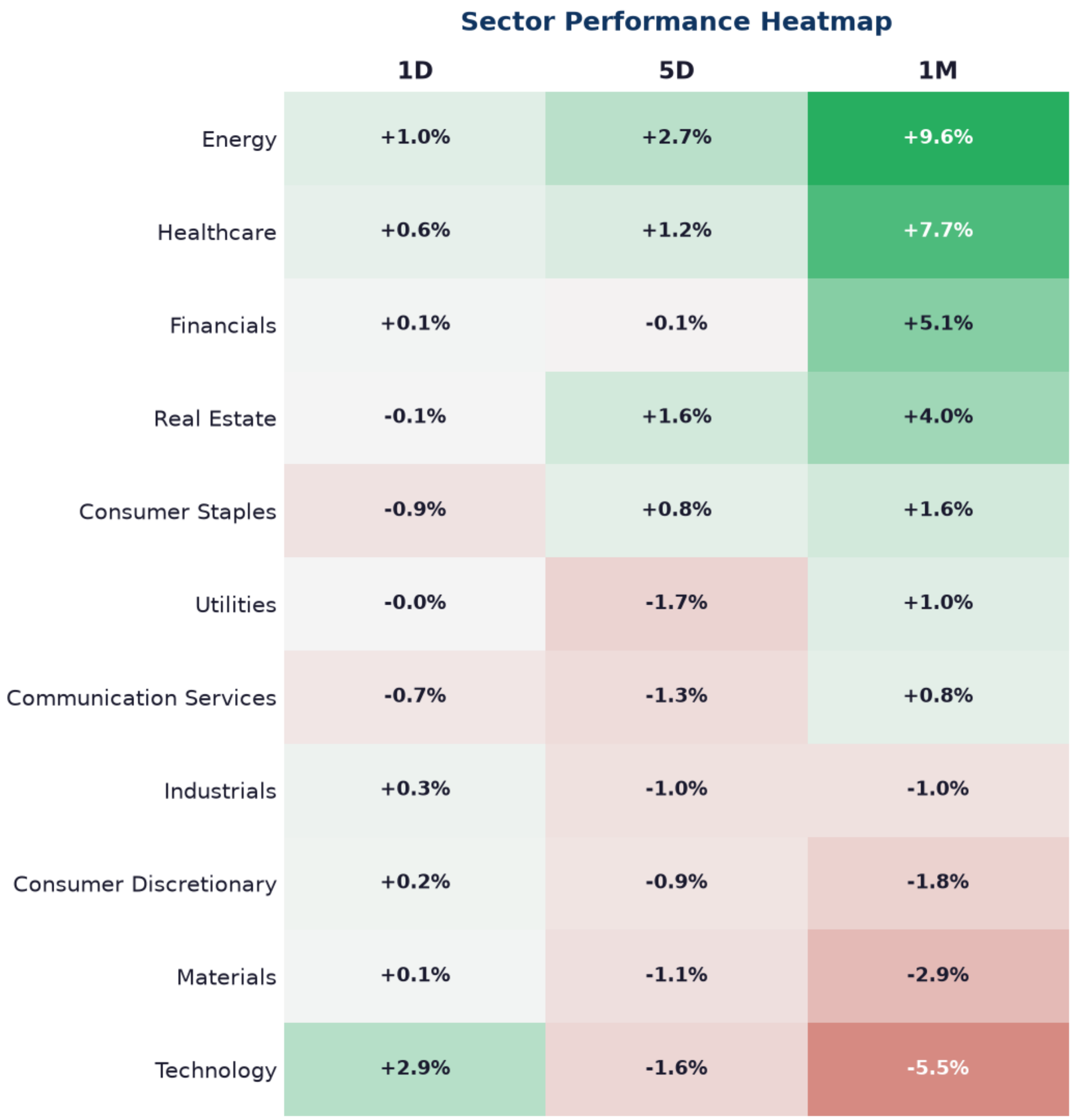
Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-07-22&to=2026-07-30&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map



Hot Now

- **Energy** — Energy shows strong momentum across 1d, 5d, and 1m, driven by oil price strength and supply constraints.
- **Healthcare** — Healthcare has consistent positive returns, supported by defensive demand and innovation in biotech.
- **Financials** — Financials benefit from rising interest rates and solid earnings, though 5d is flat.

Cold but Worth Watching

- **Technology** — Technology has negative 1m and 5d but a strong 1d bounce, suggesting potential reversal from oversold conditions.

- **Consumer Discretionary** — Consumer Discretionary is weak on 5d and 1m, but consumer spending resilience could trigger mean-reversion.
- **Materials** — Materials are down across timeframes, but infrastructure spending and commodity price stabilization offer upside.

> Cyclical sectors like Energy and Financials lead on momentum, while oversold growth sectors like Technology may be poised for a rebound.

Daily Conclusion

> Escalating geopolitical risk from the Middle East war is driving a defensive rotation out of Technology and into Energy, Healthcare, and Financials.

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